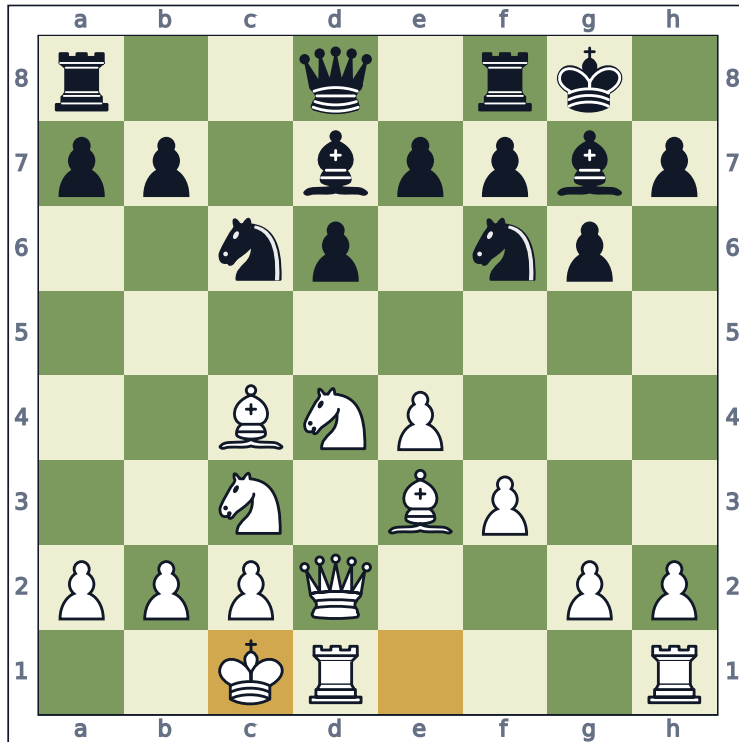


SICILIAN DEFENSE

Sicilian Defense

ECO B78 | 4 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has a meaningful objective edge. Black needs accurate counterplay.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.80 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Active and tactical: both sides must calculate forcing moves before following a thematic plan.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B78 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: Dragon Variation, Yugoslav Attack.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

BLACK'S GOALS

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

PIECE MAP

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. Black's g7 bishop is aimed at the center and queenside.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. The word 'attack' is a name, not a guarantee; complete development before forcing matters.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4, White pawn on f3.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B78 line

This section preserves all 4 names and defining routes assigned to B78 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Sicilian Defense: Dragon Variation, Yugoslav Attack

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O

002 Sicilian Defense: Dragon Variation, Yugoslav Attack, Chinese Dragon

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O Rb8

003 Sicilian Defense: Dragon Variation, Yugoslav Attack, Old Line

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O Rc8

004 Sicilian Defense: Dragon Variation, Yugoslav Attack, Topalov Variation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4 Bd7 10. O-O-O Rc8 11. Bb3 Nxd4 12. Bxd4